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Sadasivuni; Suresh

Combustor for a gas turbine

Abstract

A combustor (36) for a gas turbine, the combustor (36) comprising a combustor axis (44) about which is arranged in flow sequence a radial swirler (40), a pre-chamber (42) and a combustion chamber (38). The radial swirler (40) comprises a base plate (45), an annular array of swirler vanes (46), defining swirler slots (47), arranged around the base plate (45), a main fuel injector (48A, 48B) for injecting a main fuel and a pilot fuel injector (50) for injecting a pilot fuel. The combustor comprises a premixer nozzle (70) located on the combustion chamber (38). The premixer nozzle (70) comprising a housing (78), an array of tubes (80) within the housing (78) and a first fuel gallery (72) for supplying a first fuel (83). Each tube (80) of the array of tubes (80) comprising an inlet (86), an outlet (88), a first aperture (90) and a second aperture (92). The first fuel gallery (72) is arranged to supply the first fuel (83) to the first aperture (90) and/or the second aperture (92). In use, air (34) is supplied to the combustor and a first portion of the air (34A) passes through the radial swirler (40) and a second portion of the air (34B) passes through the tubes (80) of the array of tubes (80) from inlet (86) to outlet (88) and mixes with the first fuel (83) that passes through the first aperture (90) and/or the second aperture (92).

Inventors:	Sadasivuni; Suresh (Lincoln, GB)
Applicant:	Siemens Energy Global GmbH & Co. KG (Munich, DE)
Family ID:	1000008781912
Assignee:	SIEMENS ENERGY GLOBAL GMBH & CO. KG (Munich, DE)
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Primary Examiner: Wongwian; Phutthiwat

Assistant Examiner: Igue; Roberto Toshiharu

Background/Summary

FIELD OF INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates to a combustor for a gas turbine and particularly but not exclusively a distributed combustion system suitable for burning fuel with a significant hydrogen content or a high hydrocarbon content without flashback.

BACKGROUND OF INVENTION

(2) Current dry low emissions (DLE) combustion systems comprise a radial swirler having an annular array of vanes defining slots there between and through which compressed air passes in a radially inward and tangential direction to create a swirling fuel and air mixture. The fuel and air mixture pass through a pre-chamber and into a combustion chamber where it is burned. The DLE combustion system comprises a main fuel supply and a pilot fuel supply. The main fuel supply, usually a gas fuel, is injected from two locations in each slot of the radial swirler. In one location, there is a fuel injection hole in the base of each slot near to the entrance of the slot, i.e. in a radially outer part of the slot. In the other location, there are two side injection holes on the vanes in each slot. Mixing of main fuel may be assisted by the injector nozzle being in a counter-bore. The pilot fuel injector is located on a base plate, which defines an axial extent of the pre-chamber, and usually radially inwardly of the swirler vanes.

(3) There are two distinct flames formed in the DLE combustion system. The flame generated from the main fuel injection, which is premixed, produces the main flame and fuel injected from the pilot injector which is a diffusion flame. It is known to have a combustor with further fuel injection locations and at an axially downstream location compared to the main and pilot injectors. This is known as a Distributed Combustion System (DCS) or an axial fuel stage combustor. The main objective of using axial fuel staging is to lower CO at low loads or conserve efficiency and reduce NO_x emissions by distributing the flame so that overall maximum temperatures in the combustor are lowered.

(4) However, in the known DCS, fuel injected via the further fuel injection can only be premixed to achieve the above objectives. Hence, for existing technologies a diffusion flame in the DCS is not

possible. However, any premixing will also lead to flame flashback or flame holding if there are any local stagnation or recirculation zones created. Thus, for conventional distributed combustion systems it is not possible to use fuels with a significant hydrogen content of a high-hydrocarbon contents because flash-back will occur.

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(5) Thus, an object of the presently disclosed combustor is to provide a combustion system which prevents flame flashbacks yet provides efficient combustion with low emissions. Another object of the presently disclosed combustor is to provide better mixing of fuel and air. Another object of the presently disclosed combustor is to provide a more stable combustion process.

(6) The above objects are achieved by a combustor for a gas turbine, the combustor comprising a combustor axis about which is arranged in flow sequence a radial swirler, a pre-chamber and a combustion chamber. The radial swirler comprises a base plate, an annular array of swirler vanes defining swirler slots, arranged around the base plate, a main fuel injector for injecting a main fuel and a pilot fuel injector for injecting a pilot fuel. The combustor further comprising a premixer nozzle located on the combustion chamber. The premixer nozzle comprising a housing, an array of tubes within the housing and a first fuel gallery for supplying a first fuel. Each tube of the array of tubes comprising an inlet, an outlet, a first aperture and a second aperture. The first fuel gallery is arranged to supply the first fuel to the first aperture and/or the second aperture. In use, air is supplied to the combustor and a first portion of the air passes through the radial swirler and a second portion of the air passes through the tubes of the array of tubes from inlet to outlet and mixes with the first fuel that passes through the first aperture and/or the second aperture.

(7) The premixer nozzle may comprise a second fuel gallery for supplying a second fuel to the second aperture, in use, the second portion of air passes through the tubes of the array of tubes from inlet to outlet and mixes with the first fuel from the first fuel gallery that passes through the first aperture and the second fuel from the second fuel gallery that passes through the second aperture.

(8) At least one of the tubes, preferably all the tubes, of the array of tubes may comprise a converging portion, the converging portion converges towards the outlet, preferably the converging portion ends at the outlet.

(9) The converging portion may have a first cross-sectional area and a second cross-sectional area, the second cross-sectional area is downstream of the first cross-sectional area, and the reduction of the cross-sectional area between the first cross-sectional area and the second cross-sectional area falls within the range 10% to 40% of the first cross-sectional area.

(10) A fuel and air mixture may exit the outlet of the tube(s) at a velocity between and including 60 m/s and 100 m/s.

(11) The first and/or second fuel may exit at least one of the apertures at a velocity between and including 50 m/s and 80 m/s and into the tube.

(12) The first aperture and second aperture may oppose one another across the tube such that respective jets of first fuel and second fuel impinge on one another.

(13) The first aperture and second aperture may be directly opposite one another across the tube and are aligned with one another.

(14) The first aperture and second aperture may have different areas.

(15) At least one tube, preferably a centre tube (80A), may not have a first or second aperture.

(16) The at least one tube may have a third fuel supply arrangement for supplying a third fuel, preferably the third fuel is a liquid fuel.

(17) The first fuel and/or the second fuel may be any one or combination of a natural gas, hydrogen, a fuel comprising at least 5% hydrogen and a higher hydrocarbon fuel like liquified petroleum gas.

(18) The combustor chamber may comprise an array of premixer nozzles, preferably between and including 4 and 8 premixer nozzles.

(19) The premixer nozzles may be evenly spaced around the circumference of the combustion

chamber.

(20) The premixer nozzles may be arranged such some of the premixer nozzles are axially off-set from the other premixer nozzles.

(21) Any one or more of the main, pilot, first, second and third fuel may be each supplied by via a fuel supply line and a valve, the valve may be controllable and connected to a controller.

(22) The controller may be configured to vary the amount of any one or more of the main, pilot, first, second and third fuels either individually, collectively or simultaneously.

(23) In a second aspect of the present disclosure, there is provided a method of injecting fuel into a combustor as claimed in any one the preceding paragraphs, wherein the method comprises at least one of the steps injecting the fuel into the at least one tube from at least one of the apertures at a velocity between and including 50 m/s and 80 m/s and injecting a fuel and air mixture from the outlet of the at least one tube at a velocity between and including 60 m/s and 100 m/s.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The above-mentioned attributes and other features and advantages of the present technique and the manner of attaining them will become more apparent and the presently disclosed combustor and method of operation will be better understood by reference to the following description of embodiments of the present technique taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 shows part of a turbine engine in a sectional view and in which the present combustor is incorporated and in accordance with the present disclosure,

(3) FIG. 2 is a schematic cross-section through the presently disclosed combustor and showing a premixer nozzle,

(4) FIG. 3 is a schematic cross-section through a first embodiment of the presently disclosed premixer nozzle,

(5) FIG. 4 is a sectional view SA-SA of the premixer nozzle as shown on FIG. 3,

(6) FIG. 5 is another sectional view SA-SA of an alternative embodiment of the premixer nozzle,

(7) FIG. 6 is a schematic cross-section through a second embodiment of the presently disclosed premixer nozzle,

(8) FIG. 7 is an enlarged view of one tube of an array of tubes of the premixer nozzle,

(9) FIG. 8 is an enlarged view of an alternative embodiment of one tube of an array of tubes of the premixer nozzle.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF INVENTION

(10) FIG. 1 is a schematic illustration of a general arrangement of a turbine engine **10** having an inlet **12**, a compressor **14**, a combustor system **16**, a turbine system **18**, an exhaust duct **20** and a twin-shaft arrangement **22**, **24**. The turbine engine **10** is generally arranged about an axis **26** which for rotating components is their rotational axis. The shafts of the twin-shaft arrangement **22**, **24** may have the same or opposite directions of rotation. The combustor system **16** comprises an annular array of combustors **36**, only one of which is shown. In one example, there are six combustors **36** evenly spaced about the engine **10**. The turbine system **18** includes a high-pressure turbine **28** drivingly connected to the compressor **14** by a first shaft **22** of the twin-shaft arrangement. The turbine system **18** also includes a low-pressure turbine **30** drivingly connected to a load (not shown) via the second shaft **24** of the twin-shaft arrangement.

(11) The terms radial, circumferential and axial are with respect to the engine's rotational axis **26** or as otherwise stated. The terms upstream and downstream are with respect to the general direction of gas flow through the engine and, as seen in FIG. 1, is generally from left to right.

(12) The compressor **14** comprises an axial series of stator vanes and rotor blades mounted in a

conventional manner. The stator or compressor vanes may be fixed or have variable geometry to improve the airflow onto the downstream rotor or compressor blades. Each turbine **28, 30** comprises an axial series of stator vanes and rotor blades. The stator vanes can be mounted to a radially outer casing or a radially inner drum. The rotor blades are mounted via rotor discs arranged and operating in a conventional manner. A rotor assembly comprises an annular array of rotor blades or blades and the rotor disc.

(13) Each combustor **36** is constructed from two walls, an inner wall **37** and an outer wall **39**, between which is defined a generally annular space. At the head of the combustor **36** is a radial swirler **40** which comprises a swirl plate or base plate **45**, an annular array of swirler vanes **46** and fuel injection points as will be described in more detail later. The swirler **40** is succeeded by a pre-chamber **42** and then a main combustion chamber **38**. These combustor **36** components are generally arranged about a combustor axis **44**. The annular array of swirler vanes **46** define swirler slots **47**, arranged around the base plate **45**.

(14) In operation, air **32** is drawn into the engine **10** through the inlet **12** and into the compressor **14** where the successive stages of vanes and blades compress the air before delivering the compressed air **34** into the combustor system **16**. The compressed air **34** flows between the inner and outer walls **37, 39** and into the swirler **40**. The swirler **40** creates highly turbulent air into which the fuel is injected. The air/fuel mixture is delivered into the pre-chamber **42**, where mixing continues, and then into the main combustion chamber **38**. In the combustion chamber **38** of the combustor **36** the mixture of compressed air and fuel is ignited and burnt. The resultant hot working gas flow is directed into, expands and drives the high-pressure turbine **28** which in turn drives the compressor **14** via the first shaft **22**. After passing through the high-pressure turbine **28**, the hot working gas flow is directed into the low-pressure turbine **30** which drives the load via the second shaft **24**.

(15) The low-pressure turbine **30** can also be referred to as a power turbine and the second shaft **24** can also be referred to as a power shaft. The load is typically an electrical machine for generating electricity or a mechanical machine such as a pump or a process compressor. Other known loads may be driven via the low-pressure turbine. The fuel may be in gaseous and/or liquid form.

(16) The turbine engine **10** shown and described with reference to FIG. **1** is just one example of a number of engines or turbomachinery in which this invention can be incorporated. Such engines can be gas turbines or steam turbine and include single, double and triple shaft engines applied in marine, industrial and aerospace sectors.

(17) FIG. **2** is a cross-section through part of the combustor **36** of the turbine engine **10** described above and in accordance with the present invention. The radial swirler **40** comprises an annular array of vanes **46** which are angled tangentially relative to the combustor axis **44** to impart a swirling flow **55** of mixing air and fuel as is well known. The swirling flow **55** rotates about the combustor axis **44** and flows in a general left to right direction as seen in FIG. **2**. The swirler vanes **46** form an array of mixing channels or swirler slots **47** between each consecutive swirler vane **46**. The swirler **46** further comprises main fuel injectors **48A, 48B** for injecting a main fuel and pilot fuel injectors **50** for injecting a pilot fuel. The swirler **40** comprises the base plate **45** which has a pilot surface **52** that faces the pre-chamber **42** and bounds the pre-chamber's upstream axial extent. The pre-chamber **42** is further defined by an annular wall **54** which has parallel sides as shown in this cross-section. The pre-chamber **42** has an inlet **66** and an outlet **68**. The outlet **68** forms or is at a lip **69** of the pre-chamber **42** and defines where the pre-chamber **42** terminates. The pre-chamber's **42** annular wall **54** is then succeeded by the generally annular wall **37** of the main combustion chamber **38**. From the lip **69** and downstream the generally annular wall **37** is divergent and opens to define the main combustion chamber **38**. The main combustion chamber **38** has a greater cross-sectional area than that of the pre-chamber **42**.

(18) There are two distinct fuel/air mixtures and subsequently combustion flames in the combustion chamber **38**; a pilot flame **56** is derived from the pilot fuel/air mixture and the main flame **58** is derived from the main fuel/air mixture. The pilot flame **56** and the main flame **58** are

distinct from one another because of the location of the respective fuel injection points within the air flow **34A** in or near to the mixing channel(s) **47**. The main fuel injectors **48A**, **48B** inject main fuel into the swirler slot or mixing channel **47** further away from, i.e. radially outwardly of, the combustor axis **44** than the pilot fuel injector(s) **50**. Thus, the respective fuel/air mixtures form substantially different flame regions with the pilot flame **56** generally radially inward of the main flame **58**.

(19) Radial swirlers, as in the case here, have or can be defined as having, a swirl number SN. The swirl number can be calculated as is well known in the art, suffice to say here, that the swirl number can be defined by a relationship between the fluxes of angular and linear momentum of the fuel/air mixture. That is to say, the angular momentum relates to rotational velocity about the combustor axis **44** and the linear momentum relates to the velocity in the axial direction along the combustor axis **44**. Thus, the SN is defined herein as the ratio of tangential momentum to axial momentum of the fluid or fuel/air mixture.

(20) The general schematic cross section of FIG. 2 shows a Dry Low Emissions (DLE) combustor **36**. The known radial swirler **40** described above has a SN in the region 0.5 to 0.8. This combustor provides a good DLE burner for combusting methane and medium calorific value fuels (MCV fuels) containing hydrocarbons. However, this current design is not suitable for burning fuel with significant (e.g. >5% by weight) hydrogen or high-hydrocarbon content mainly due to dominance of a significantly higher flame speed on the flow characteristics. The presence of hydrogen or high-hydrocarbon in the fuel increases flame speed and causes flash-back into the pre-chamber **42**. This is clearly detrimental and undesirable and can cause extinction of the flame and increased emissions of nitrous oxides, sulphur oxides and unburned hydrocarbons amongst other undesirable combustion by products.

(21) The present combustor **36** comprises a premixer nozzle **70** which is located on the wall **37** of the combustion chamber **38**. As shown in this example, the combustor **36** comprises first fuel supply line **72** and a second fuel supply line **74** and valves **73** and **75** respectively situated on the first fuel supply line **72** and the second fuel supply line **74**. Each of the valves **73**, **75** is connected to a controller **76**. The controller **76** may be part of the gas turbine engine's electronic control unit. The valves **73**, **75** are independently controllable to and between open and close to vary the amount for fuel flowing therethrough and to the premixer nozzle **70**. The valves **73**, **75** (and the valve **99** described with reference to FIG. 4 later) may be operated independently or together in an open loop or closed loop configuration to control emissions, performance and engine output.

(22) Although only one premixer nozzle **70** is shown on FIG. 2, the exemplary combustor chamber **36** comprises an array of premixer nozzles **70**. In one example, there are 4 premixer nozzles **70** and which are even spaced about the circumference of the combustion chamber **36**. In other examples, there may be up to and including 8 premixer nozzles. The premixer nozzles **70** are all located at the same axial position relative to the combustor axis **44**; however, in other examples there may be two or more axial positions such that, in circumferential sequence, alternate premixer nozzles **70** are axially off-set from one another.

(23) FIG. 3 shows a partial cut away of the premixer nozzle **70**. The premixer nozzle **70** comprises a housing **78** and an array of tubes **80** within the housing **78**. The housing **78** is secured to the combustor wall **37** in a conventional manner such as welding. The array of tubes **80** has a centreline **89** and which is generally aligned radially inwardly at the combustor axis **44**. In other embodiments the centreline **89** may be axially angled relative to the axial line (i.e. away from a radial line) and/or tangentially angled in either direction.

(24) Each tube **80** of the array of tubes **80** comprises an inlet **86** at a radially outer part of the premixer nozzle **70** and an outlet **88** at a radially inner part of the premixer nozzle **70**. Each tube **80** has a first aperture **90** and a second aperture **92**. The apertures **90**, **92** are located nearer the inlet **86** than the outlet **88**. The premixer nozzle **70** has a first fuel gallery **72** for supplying a first fuel **83** and a second fuel gallery **74** for supplying a second fuel **85**.

(25) The premixer nozzle **70** is formed by an additive manufacturing process such as laser deposition and therefore complex configurations of the array of tubes **80** and fuel galleries **72**, **74** can easily be formed as a monolithic structure.

(26) In use, air **34** is supplied to the combustor **36** and a first portion **34A** of the air passes through the radial swirler **40** and a second portion **34B** of the air passes through the tubes **80** of the array of tubes **80** in the direction from inlet **86** to outlet **88** and which is generally radially inwardly towards the combustor axis **44**. The air **34B** mixes with the first fuel **83** that passes through the first aperture **90** and the second fuel **85** that passes through the second aperture **92** of each tube **80**. The air and fuel mix with one another in the tubes **80** before being injected through the outlet **88** and into the combustion chamber **38**.

(27) FIG. **4** is a section SA-SA of the premixer nozzle **70** as seen on FIG. **3**. Here one example of the arrangement of the array of tubes **80** can be seen. The tubes **80** are packed together tightly such that diagonal rows are off-set from one another in a body-centred fashion. Alternatively, in FIG. **5** which is a section SA-SA of the premixer nozzle **70** as seen on FIG. **3**, the tubes **80** are arranged around the outer periphery of, but inside, the housing **78**. In both examples, at least one tube **80A** does not have a first or second aperture **90**, **92**. This tube **80A** is located centrally of the array of tubes **80**. However, not only may there be other tubes **80A**, but the tube(s) **80A** may be located off-centre. For this tube **80A**, only air **34B** passes therethrough. The main purpose of the tube **80A** is to feed air only and directly from supply **34B** to provide sufficient oxygen to burn out any CO that the premixer nozzle **70** might produce at or immediately surrounding outlet **88**. Further, the tube **80A** ensures that the premixer nozzle **70** has some degree of air to mix with the fuel-air mixture exiting from other tubes **80** and which enhances features like air assist to vary the local equivalence ratio and hence temperature of the flame. In another example, a third fuel **97** may be supplied via a third fuel supply arrangement **98**. The third fuel supply arrangement **98** comprises a valve **99** for varying the amount of third fuel **97**. The valve **99** is controllable via the controller **76**. Preferably, the third fuel **97** is a liquid fuel, but may be a gaseous fuel. The tube **80A** may have a greater cross-sectional area than the other tubes **80**.

(28) FIG. **6** is an enlarged view of one tube **80** of the array of tubes **80** of the premixer nozzle **70**. The tube **80** has a converging portion **102** that converges towards the outlet **88**. The tube **80** has a generally constant cross-sectional area portion **100** that is located radially outwardly of the converging portion **102**. The generally constant cross-sectional area portion **100** is arranged parallel or approximately parallel to the centreline **89**. The converging portion **102** is angled towards the centreline **89** relative to the direction of gas flow therethrough or considering the direction towards the outlet **88** from the inlet **86**. Within portion **100** the first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92** are located. Nonetheless, in other embodiment the first aperture **90** and/or second aperture **92** may be located in the converging portion **102**. Further, the whole tube **80** may converge from the inlet **86** to the outlet **88**. The converging portion **102** has a cross-sectional area and the cross-sectional area of the converging portion **102** reduces between 10% and 40% towards the outlet of the tube **80**. FIGS. **6** and **8** show cross-sectional areas **A1** and **A2**. Area **A1** is upstream of area **A2**. The percentage of area change (e.g. between **A1** and **A2**) is at least partly dependent the fuel composition being used. The higher the hydrogen content and/or the higher-hydrocarbon based fuels the greater the reduction in cross-sectional area required. The greater the percentage of reduction in cross-sectional area means a corresponding increase in the velocity of the fuel exiting from the tubes **80**. Preferably, from the cross-section **A1** to the cross-section **A2** of the tubes **80** the reduction in cross-sectional area falls within the range 10% to 40% of the cross-sectional area of the cross-section **A1**. It should be noted that all the tubes may have the same reduction in cross-sectional area or some of the tubes **80** may have a different reduction in cross-sectional area than other tubes **80**. The reduction of the cross-sectional area of each tube **80** may be further based on the number of premixer nozzles **70** and number of tubes **80** each premixer nozzle **70** has. Any specific design of the premixer nozzle **70** and including the rate of convergence, fuel and air

pressures and combustion chamber pressure should be such that the fuel and air mixture exits the tube outlets **88** at a velocity between and including 60 m/s and 100 m/s.

(29) One of the first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92** are located radially outwardly of the other and in this example the second aperture **92** is located radially outwardly of the first aperture **90**. The second fuel **85** is injected into the tube **80** as a jet where it impinges on the air **34B** and begins to mix, then the first fuel **83** is injected into the air and fuel mixture and further creates turbulence to enhance mixing of the fuel and air. Fuels with higher hydrocarbon content are injected from the first aperture **90** as the first fuel **83** and fuels which are lighter, e.g. having a hydrogen content, are injected from the second aperture **92** as the second fuel **85**. One reason for this is that heavier hydrocarbon-based fuels need longer residence time in the tubes **80** to mix with the air than lighter fuels such as those with a hydrogen content. The first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92** are off-set from one another relative to the direction of air **34B** flow. It is an advantage of the design that the two fuel jets impinge on one another to enhance turbulence and therefore mixing of air and fuel prior to injection into the combustion chamber **38**. Thus, the two apertures **90** and **92** should be positioned accordingly and preferably within twice the sectional width (or diameter) of the tube **80**.

(30) FIG. 7 is a schematic cross-section through a second embodiment of the presently disclosed premixer nozzle **70**. Here, the second gallery **84**, the second fuel supply line **74** and valve **75** are omitted when compared to the first embodiment of the premixer nozzle **70** described with reference to FIG. 3. Other features are similar to the first embodiment and will not be described again.

(31) The first fuel gallery **82** is arranged to supply the first fuel **83** to the first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92** in each tube **80**. In other words, the first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92** are within the first fuel gallery **82**. In use, air **34** is supplied to the combustor **36** and a first portion **34A** of the air passes through the swirler and a second portion of the air passes through the tubes **80** of the array of tubes **80** from inlet **86** to outlet **88** and mixes with the first fuel **83** that passes through the first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92**.

(32) FIG. 8 is an enlarged view of an alternative embodiment of one a tube **80** of an array of tubes **80** of the second embodiment of the premixer nozzle **70**. Similar features are given similar reference numbers compared to the FIG. 6 embodiment and are not described again. In this second embodiment, the first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92** are aligned with one another across the tube **80**. That is, the first aperture **90** and the second aperture **92** direct a jet of first fuel **83** to impinge on one another and approximately in the centre of the tube **80**. The impingement of the two fuel jets creates turbulence and enhanced mixing with the air **34B** which is highly desirable.

(33) For the first embodiment and the second embodiment of the premixing nozzle **70**, the fuel exits at least one of the apertures **90**, **92** and preferably both at a velocity between and including 50 m/s and 80 m/s. The apertures **90**, **92** are sized accordingly and in view of the viscosity and density of the fuel type as well as the pressure of the fuel supply. Thus, one of the apertures **90**, **92** may have a different outlet area to the other aperture **92**, **90**. Once mixed with the air **34B**, the fuel and air mixture exits the tube outlet **88** at a velocity between and including 60 m/s and 100 m/s.

(34) All the features disclosed in this specification (including any accompanying claims, abstract and drawings), and/or all the steps of any method or process so disclosed, may be combined in any combination, except combinations where at least some of such features and/or steps are mutually exclusive.

(35) Each feature disclosed in this specification (including any accompanying claims, abstract and drawings) may be replaced by alternative features serving the same, equivalent or similar purpose, unless expressly stated otherwise. Thus, unless expressly stated otherwise, each feature disclosed is one example only of a generic series of equivalent or similar features.

(36) The invention is not restricted to the details of the foregoing embodiment(s). The invention extends to any novel one, or any novel combination, of the features disclosed in this specification

(including any accompanying claims, abstract and drawings), or to any novel one, or any novel combination, of the steps of any method or process so disclosed.

Claims

1. A combustor for a gas turbine, the combustor comprising: a combustor axis about which is arranged in flow sequence, a radial swirler, a pre-chamber and a combustion chamber, wherein the radial swirler comprises: a base plate, an annular array of swirler vanes, defining swirler slots, arranged around the base plate, a main fuel injector for injecting a main fuel and a pilot fuel injector for injecting a pilot fuel, wherein the combustor further comprises: a premixer nozzle located in the combustion chamber, the radial swirler disposed upstream relative to the premixer nozzle and in fluid communication with the pre-chamber, the premixer nozzle comprising: a housing, an array of tubes within the housing of the premixer nozzle, and a first fuel gallery for supplying a first fuel, each tube of the array of tubes comprising an inlet, an outlet, a first aperture and a second aperture, wherein the first aperture and the second aperture of each tube of the array of tubes are respectively disposed relatively closer to the inlet than to the outlet, wherein the inlet of each tube of the array of tubes is fluidly connected to receive compressed air from a compressor connected to the gas turbine, wherein the first fuel gallery is arranged to supply the first fuel to the first aperture and/or the second aperture of each tube of the array of tubes, wherein the premixer nozzle further comprises a second fuel gallery for supplying a second fuel to the second aperture, wherein, in use, a first portion of the compressed air is arranged to pass through the radial swirler to be conveyed directly from the pre-chamber to the combustion chamber, and a second portion of the compressed air is directly conveyed to the premixer nozzle to pass through the tubes of the array of tubes from the inlet to the outlet, wherein the second portion of the compressed air mixes with the first fuel and the second fuel as the second portion of the compressed air travels from the inlet to the outlet of each tube of the array of tubes within the housing of the premixer nozzle.
2. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein at least one of the tubes of the array of tubes comprises a converging portion, the converging portion converges towards the outlet, wherein the converging portion ends at the outlet.
3. The combustor as claimed in claim 2, wherein the converging portion has a first cross-sectional area and a second cross-sectional area, the second cross-sectional area is downstream of the first cross-sectional area, and the reduction of the cross-sectional area between the first cross-sectional area and the second cross-sectional area falls within the range from 10% to 40% of the first cross-sectional area.
4. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein a respective mixture of the first fuel, the second fuel and air exit from the outlets of each tube of the array of tubes at a velocity between and including 60 m/s and 100 m/s.
5. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first fuel and/or the second fuel exits at least one of the apertures at a velocity between and including 50 m/s and 80 m/s and into the tube.
6. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first aperture and second aperture oppose one another across the tube such that respective jets of the first fuel and the second fuel impinge on one another.
7. The combustor as claimed in claim 6 wherein the first aperture and second aperture are directly opposite one another across the tube and are aligned with one another.
8. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first aperture and second aperture have different areas.
9. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein at least one tube of the array of tubes comprises a centre tube, and the centre tube does not have a first aperture or a second aperture.
10. The combustor as claimed in claim 9 wherein the at least one tube has a third fuel supply arrangement for supplying a third fuel, wherein the third fuel is a liquid fuel.

11. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first fuel and/or the second fuel are any one or combination of a natural gas, hydrogen, a fuel comprising at least 5% hydrogen and a higher hydrocarbon fuel like liquified petroleum gas.
 12. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein the combustion chamber comprises an array of premixer nozzles, between and including 4 and 8 premixer nozzles.
 13. The combustor as claimed in claim 12 wherein the premixer nozzles are evenly spaced around the circumference of the combustion chamber.
 14. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein the premixer nozzles are arranged such that some of the premixer nozzles are axially off-set from the other premixer nozzles.
 15. The combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein any one or more of the main fuel, the pilot fuel, the first fuel, and the second fuel are each supplied by a fuel supply line and a valve, wherein the valve is controllable and is connected to a controller, and wherein the controller is configured to vary the amount of any one or more of the main fuel, the pilot fuel, the first fuel, and the second fuel either individually, collectively or simultaneously.
 16. A method of injecting fuel into the combustor as claimed in claim 1, wherein the method comprises at least one of the following steps: injecting the first fuel and/or the second fuel into at least one tube of the array of tubes through at least one of the apertures of the at least one tube of the array of tubes at a velocity between and including 50 m/s and 80 m/s and injecting a mixture of fuel and air from the outlet of the at least one tube of the array of tubes at a velocity between and including 60 m/s and 100 m/s.
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